DATAVIZ 2026 · FOOD · STORY DESCRIPTION

# The Food Atlas: The price of eating well

A healthy diet is getting more expensive – yet fewer people are priced out of it. Between 2017 and 2025, its daily cost rose from 2.94 to 4.28 PPP dollars per person, while the share unable to afford it fell from 41% to 33%.

But progress has left one region behind. Sub-Saharan Africa now has 194 million more people priced out than in 2017 – more than one in three of the world's total.

The divide is income, not price. In 2025, a healthy diet cost 4.18 PPP dollars a day in both Nigeria and Cyprus, yet 80% of Nigerians could not afford it, against under 2% of Cypriots. On the plate, animal-source foods make up 38% of the cost in low-income countries, versus 24% in high-income ones (2021 country medians).

Being fed is not the same as being well fed. In Niger in 2024, 13% of people lacked enough calories, but 87% could not afford a healthy diet and nearly half of young children were stunted.

Our atlas traces this story from global prices to children's growth, linking affordability to SDG targets 2.1 (ending hunger) and 2.2 (ending malnutrition).

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**Data story:** claude.ai/artifact/XEx3UYEenFW9wL8zqdgZJw

**Interactive dashboard:** food-atlas-3bk2nk.streamlit.app

198 words including the title. Team 3BK2NK, Macquarie University.

Data: World Bank, Food Prices for Nutrition 5.0 (2026); World Bank, World Development Indicators and Country and Lending Groups (FY2027); FAO, FAOSTAT Suite of Food Security Indicators; UNICEF, WHO and World Bank, Joint Child Malnutrition Estimates (2026). PPP dollars are international dollars adjusted for purchasing power. Relationships described are associations across countries, not proof of cause.